Skills Assessment Application
ACS Recognition of Prior Learning Assessment Pathway
Documents Required

Please provide **high quality, colour scanned copies** of the following **original** documents which will be used to support your skills assessment application. Please note that you will need to provide acceptable English translations for any documents that are not in English.

Please tick the boxes on this check sheet to show what documents you have provided. We have stated 'N/A' where you do <u>not</u> need to provide documents.

DOCUMENTS REQUIRED	
IDENTITY You will complete this step yourself. The portal will prompt you to scan and upload the required documents using a QR code and your smartphone camera.	
Passport Applicant details page only (not full passport). Ensure that the name used in your application matches the name in your passport.	
One additional government-issued identity document from your country of birth or current residence that bears your photograph.	
Evidence of change of name (if applicable) due to marriage or other reasons (i.e. current name does not match name on a qualification or experience).	
Experience Evidence	
Resume/Curriculum Vitae	
Clear original colour scans of **Employment References** detailing periods of employment and other key details	
OR, if you are unable to obtain an Employment Reference, clear original colour scans of statutory declaration from a colleague (deponent) confirming your duties, position title, start and finish dates and their work relationship with you	
Clear original colour scan of your service/employment certificate	
Clear original colour scan of the deponent's service/employment certificate	
Clear original colour scan of a letter of explanation from your employer	

Payment Evidence	
Clear original colour scans of **two forms of Payment Evidence** covering the beginning and end of each period of employment Please consolidate in 1 PDF per type of pay evidence per employer	
If licensing/registration required for your occupation: Evidence of your ability to meet licensing or registration requirements	
Completed ACS Recognition of Prior Learning Form	
You must submit **two Project Reports** within an ACS Recognition of Prior Learning Form to demonstrate how you applied your IT knowledge in a working situation.	
Professional Currency Evidence	
You must submit at least **two forms of evidence** from the Professional Currency Evidence list that demonstrates your skill and currency in the nominated ANZSCO code(s).	
Qualification Evidence	
Copy of your award certificate, TOR, and letter of completion (if applicable)	

WE CAN HELP YOU OBTAIN YOUR DOCUMENTS

Please let us know if you require assistance in obtaining any of these documents, including:

- **English translations of any documents that are not in English:** We can obtain quotes from translators accepted by the skills assessing authority.

FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS

All references must contain the following specific information from the employer:

1. Company Letterhead, Employer name, Address
2. Company website URL address
3. Your Full Name
4. Date of letter
5. Start and End dates of employment in DD/MM/YYYY format (If your position is current, the reference should show the start date, and for the end date, indicate 'current' or 'till date')
    - 5B Note - If you have held multiple positions over a long tenure, then please insert a simple table with columns Position Title, Start Date, End Date, Location. Then add a row for each Position Title held (refer to 5B in example image)
6. Employment status (permanent full-time, part-time, contractor)
7. Minimum number of hours worked per week
8. Annual Salary before tax and any benefits (as per your company's guidelines)
9. Location of work – this will either be 'Australia' or 'Outside Australia' for each Position held.
10. Position/Role Title e.g. 'Software Engineer', 'Database Administrator'
11. Bullet point duties performed – this must confirm the duties <u>you carried out</u> in the role.
    - 11B Note – If you have held multiple positions over a long tenure, then you must provide bullet point duties <u>under each position held</u> with start and end dates in DD/MM/YYYY format.
12. Signed by an authorised person from the company (digital signatures are preferred and must be provided with a digital verification certificate that authenticates the signers identity)
13. Contact details of the signatory i.e. Full Name, Position Title, Phone Number and Work Email Address (no personal email address)

ACS acknowledges that every employer is different and may be bound by company reference letter layout templates. An example reference letter layout covering the numbers above is presented for your understanding.

If you cannot obtain an employment reference or are self-employed, you will need to submit a **Statutory Declaration** or **Affidavit**.

Statutory declarations and affidavits will only be accepted in situations where an applicant is unable to obtain an Employment Reference. The applicant will be required to provide a letter or official email from the company explaining why an employment reference letter cannot be provided.

The statutory declaration or affidavit must be written by a **work colleague in a managerial or supervisory role**, who worked with you and witnessed your day-to-day duties for the duration of your employment. Self-written statutory declarations or affidavits will not be accepted.

A statutory declaration or affidavit written by a work colleague needs to describe their working relationship with you, the duties you performed and relevant dates of employment. It must also cover the key areas that would be in an employment reference letter as listed below:

1. Employer name and address
2. Company website URL address
3. Your Full name
4. Date of letter
5. Start and end date of employment in DD/MM/YYYY format (If your position is current, then show the start date, and for the end date, indicate 'current' or 'till date')
6. Employment status (permanent full-time, part-time, contractor)
7. Minimum number of hours worked per week
8. Annual Salary before tax and any benefits (as per your company's guidelines)
9. Location of work – this will either be 'Australia' or 'Outside Australia' for each Position held.
10. Position/Role Title e.g. 'Software Engineer', 'Database Administrator'
11. Bullet point duties performed – this must confirm the duties you carried out in the role. If you have held multiple positions over a long tenure, then you must provide bullet point duties under each position held with start and end dates in DD/MM/YYYY format.
12. Full Name, Postion Title and Contact Details for the Work Colleague.

IN ADDITION, the document must state that it was Sworn Before, Signed Before or Witnessed Before the authorised witness by the referee (work colleague) and must be signed by the authorised witness, with the date and place where the declaration was made.

List of Authorised Witnesses in Australia →

If obtaining a statutory declaration or affidavit outside Australia, please refer to an Australian Embassy or the legal standard of the country in which you are applying.

An example of how to define a working relationship:

'I can confirm that (applicant name) carried out the duties and role specified in this document at (company name) as I was their (supervisor, manager etc.) who interacted with them and witnessed their work regularly throughout their employment.'

The declarant (senior work colleague) must provide their current contact details (preferably email and phone number) and at least one of the following as evidence of their working relationship with the applicant:

- Current Employment Certificate/Statement of Service on official company letterhead. This should show start date in DD/MM/YYYY format.
- Leaving Certificate on official company letterhead (if no longer working at the same company) This should show start date and end date in DD/MM/YYYY format.

All statutory declarations or affidavits must be accompanied by the applicant's Employment Certificate/Statement of Service with start date in DD/MM/YYYY format and end date in DD/MM/YYY if left company.

PLEASE NOTE: Acceptance of statutory declarations or affidavits in place of employment references will be subject to the verification and discretion of ACS and noted to the Department of Home Affairs for authentication against fraud and plagiarism.

Statutory Declarations or Affidavits will be assessed as **NOT SUITABLE** when:

- they do **NOT** contain words to the effect **Sworn Before, Signed Before or Witnessed Before**
- the declarant (senior work colleague) does not have an overlapping employment with the applicant in the same organization.
- they are from a junior colleague
- they state that the referee agrees with what the applicant has written in another document
- the stamp and signature of the authorised witness (such as a Notary Public) does not state that the referee's signature is witnessed.
- the signature of the authorised witness only states **Attested Copy**
- the declaration is **NOT** witnessed on the same day
- the statutory declaration or affidavit has been altered since the declaration was witnessed
- the descriptions of employment duties have been copied and pasted directly from ANZSCO Description of employment duties or other references

Self-employed applicants

Self-employment is when you own or run your own business or company as an individual or in partnership. Self-employed applicants should submit a formal self-written Statutory Declaration containing:

- commencement and completion dates of your self-employment
- the occupation of employment and the capacity in which self-employed
- the nature and content of the work you performed
- number of staff employed and their occupations (if applicable)

PLEASE NOTE: The document **must state** that it was Sworn Before, Signed Before or Witnessed Before an authorised witness and **must be signed** by the authorised witness, with the date and place where the declaration was made.

Please include the following additional supporting documentation:

- Business registration certificates covering the period of self-employment
- A statement on a letterhead from your accountant or legal representative certifying the name and nature of your business, your full name and role in the company and how long you have been continuously self-employed
- Formal statements from your clients on the clients' letterhead with details of the work performed and dates – these statements should cover the entirety of the experience claimed and also mention the minimum number of hours worked per week
- Payment evidence showing regular income from self-employment, such as client invoices together with corresponding bank statements and/ or official taxation records
- Supplementary evidence, such as contracts with clients or suppliers.

List of Authorised Witnesses in Australia →

If obtaining a statutory declaration or affidavit outside Australia, please refer to an Australian Embassy or the legal standard of the country in which you are applying.

WHERE TO SEND YOUR DOCUMENTS

High quality, colour scanned copies should be provided through the **Client Portal, as soon as practicable**. As mentioned above, scanned copies are acceptable in the first instance; however you may need to send original or certified copies of some of your documents to us before we lodge your application.